Pandemic · Setup

Z-Man Games · 2–4 players · edition: Z-Man rulebook (publisher site, 2024-09 upload)

CHANGES BY PLAYER COUNT

Players	Starting hand (cards each)
2	4
3	**3**
4	2

GOAL AND LOSS

1. Cooperative game: everyone wins or loses together. Win by discovering cures for all 4 diseases (blue, yellow, black, red).
2. You lose if 8 outbreaks occur, if the cubes of a colour run out when you need one, or if the player deck runs out when you must draw.

SETUP STEPS

1. Put the board within reach. Keep the 6 research stations and the disease cubes (sorted into 4 colour piles) nearby. Place 1 research station in Atlanta.
2. Put the outbreak marker on the 0 space of the Outbreaks Track, and the 4 cure markers vial side up near the Discovered Cure Indicators.
3. Each player gets a reference card. Shuffle the role cards and deal one face up to each player. Put the matching pawns in Atlanta and remove the unused roles and pawns from the game.
4. Take the epidemic cards out of the player deck. Shuffle the remaining city and event cards and deal starting hands according to player count.
5. Infection rate marker goes on the left-most "2" space. Shuffle the infection deck and flip 3 cards, putting 3 cubes of the matching colour on each of those cities. Flip 3 more with 2 cubes each, then 3 more with 1 cube each: 9 cities and 18 cubes in total. Those 9 cards go face up in the infection discard pile.
6. Choose difficulty by the number of epidemic cards: 4 (Introductory), 5 (Standard) or 6 (Heroic). The rulebook suggests 4 for a first game.
7. Build the player deck: split the remaining player cards into as many equal-as-possible face-down piles as you have epidemic cards, shuffle one epidemic card into each pile, then stack the piles with the smaller ones on the bottom.
8. First player is the one holding the city card with the highest population.

ON A TURN

1. A turn has three parts: do 4 actions, draw 2 player cards (resolving epidemics and discarding down to 7 cards), then infect cities. Play passes to the left.

Sources: Pandemic Rulebook (Z-Man Games). AI-drafted from the publisher's rulebook and not yet human-reviewed; the rulebook is authoritative. Not affiliated with the publisher. Rogue v0 · open source.